



Ethicare Resourcing

NORTH ISLAND GUIDE · 2026

RELOCATION GUIDE

Auckland

Tāmaki Makaurau

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Auckland.

Two harbours, fifty volcanoes. The widest choice of work in the country.

Tāmaki Makaurau means Tāmaki desired by many, and it still is. A third of New Zealand lives here, between a sheltered gulf and a wild Tasman coast. This guide covers what the work is like, where people live, how to plan around housing, and how families spend their weekends.

~1.7m

people, about a third of
New Zealand

48

volcanic cones, most of
them public parks

200+

ethnicities; four in ten
born overseas

4

major public hospitals,
plus a growing private
sector

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why people choose Auckland

Built on dormant volcanoes between two harbours, Auckland was prized long before it was a city. Here is what living in it actually feels like, and who it suits best.

The first reason is the work. A third of the country lives here, which means four major public hospitals, every subspecialty, and room to move sideways in your career without moving city.

The second is the people. More than two hundred ethnicities live here, and Auckland is the largest Polynesian city in the world. In practice, your food, your festivals and your place of worship almost certainly already exist.

The third is the coast. Islands, surf beaches and native rainforest all sit inside an hour of the city centre. Not a holiday: a Tuesday evening.



I thought Auckland was going to feel really busy because it's New Zealand's biggest city. But coming from London, it feels so much slower and more relaxed. Being able to finish work and head to the beach is something I could only have dreamed of before we moved.

FESTUS, RADIOGRAPHER, MOVED FROM LONDON TO AUCKLAND



The city across the Waitematā, from the headland at Bastion Point.

The reason nobody mentions is how quickly the pace of your week changes. It tends to land around week three, usually on an ordinary Wednesday. The work is as full and rewarding as anywhere; what changes is the evening. Shops shut earlier, people leave on time more often, and the weekend is broadly agreed to be for something other than work.



A weekday lunchtime on the lawn in downtown Auckland.

WHAT IT DOES BRILLIANTLY

The deepest job market

Four major hospitals and every subspecialty, without changing city.

Community from almost anywhere

Halal butchers, Asian supermarkets, Pacific markets and the largest Pacific festival in the world.

The outdoors on the doorstep

Islands, surf beaches and rainforest inside an hour of the centre.

The main international airport

Direct flights to much of the world, so trips home and visits from family are as easy as they get in New Zealand.

GOOD TO KNOW

Housing

Auckland sits at the top of New Zealand's housing market, and wages are higher too. Plan rent first and the rest falls into place.

Getting around

Trains, busways and ferries keep growing, and most households also keep a car for the beaches and weekends.

February humidity

A warmer, stickier summer than Europe's, and the perfect excuse for a swim after work.

Trips home

Most people enjoy one long trip home a year, and Australia and the Pacific are only a few hours away.

It suits you best if...



You want the widest choice of roles, specialties and career moves without changing city.



Beaches, islands and bush on your doorstep matter more to you than snow. The ski fields are a long weekend away.



You'd enjoy living car-light: choose a suburb near a ferry, busway or train line and the city opens up.



You'd love a big, multicultural city where your food, festivals and community already exist.



You like to plan housing first. If more space for your salary tops your list, Waikato, Christchurch and the Bay of Plenty are worth a look too.

How the city is laid out

Auckland sits on an isthmus barely two kilometres across at its narrowest, with the Waitematā Harbour on one side and the Manukau on the other. That shape explains almost everything about the commute.

The volcanic field beneath the city has erupted around fifty times in 200,000 years, and each eruption left a cone, a crater or a lava flow. The result is a city interrupted, pleasantly, by hills, most of them public parks. Most suburbs have a hill you can walk up before work; the flat run between them is where the motorways went.

Māori built fortified pā on the largest cones. Maungawhau (Mount Eden), Maungakiekie (One Tree Hill) and Takarunga (Mount Victoria) still carry the terracing, and the view from the top is the quickest way to understand how the city fits together. Rangitoto, the youngest cone, rose from the sea only about 600 years ago.



Devonport on the North Shore, with the city centre across the Waitematā.



Tāmaki Makaurau

FROM C. 1350

Māori settlement across the isthmus: gardens, portage routes between the harbours, and pā on the volcanic cones.



A colonial capital

1840S

Briefly the seat of government before it moved to Wellington. British and Irish settlers, and a port that never stopped growing.



The Pacific arrives

1950S–70S

Samoa, Tongan, Cook Island and Niuean families came for work, largely to South and West Auckland.



Asia, and everywhere

1990S ONWARD

Chinese, Indian, Korean, Filipino and South African communities reshaped whole suburbs, and the food with them.



Two hundred ethnicities

TODAY

Roughly four in ten Aucklanders were born overseas. In a hospital tearoom you are unremarkable, in the best possible way.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Around 20–24° by day, humid, and light until about nine. The sea is warmest in February, not January.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 17–21°. Still swimming weather into April, and the easiest season to arrive in.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Around 11–15°, mild and green. Frost is rare and there is no snow to shovel.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 15–19°, changeable and full of blossom. Four seasons in a day is a cliché because it is accurate.

From a few days before Christmas until well into January, New Zealand takes its summer holiday. Trades go away, offices run on skeleton staff and businesses close with a note on the door. It is a lovely time to be on holiday and a slower time to set up a home, so if you can choose a start date, February or late March makes settling in easiest.



Mild winters and warm homes

Auckland winters are mild, and a few simple habits keep an older home warm and dry. Many older houses are single-glazed and heated a room at a time, so the trick is keeping damp at bay: open windows for ten minutes each morning, run a dehumidifier overnight, dry washing outside or in a ventilated room, and heat the room you're in with the door shut.

Healthcare and work in Auckland

Public healthcare is delivered by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora as a single national organisation, and Auckland's services sit across three metropolitan districts. Alongside it runs a private sector growing faster than anyone can remember.

CENTRAL ISTHMUS

The central tertiary campus

One of New Zealand's largest tertiary hospitals, with the national children's hospital on the same campus. Most inner suburbs are a short commute.

SOUTH

The South Auckland hospital

Known nationally for trauma, burns and plastic surgery, serving one of the most diverse catchments in the country.

ACROSS THE BRIDGE

The North Shore hospital

Acute, medical and surgical care for a fast-growing Shore. Many staff live on the Shore and enjoy a short, local commute.

WEST

The West Auckland hospital

Medical, maternity and outpatient services, with the Waitākere Ranges and the west-coast beaches on the doorstep.

Auckland's private hospitals do mostly planned work: surgery, endoscopy, diagnostics and day procedures, funded by insurance, by ACC, by patients, and increasingly by outsourced public lists. Many specialists work across both sectors in one week. Private hospitals are also a substantial employer of theatre nurses, anaesthetic technicians, radiographers, sonographers and recovery staff.

Beyond the hospitals sit three more employers: general practice, community radiology networks running their own MRI, CT and ultrasound, and community and NGO services, from district nursing to hospice, mental health and Māori and Pacific providers.

Six things that work differently here

- ✓ Teams are close-knit: a broad case mix, and you'll know the ward clerk by name.
- ✓ Te ao Māori is embedded, not added on: karakia, te reo and whānau in decisions as a matter of course.
- ✓ Hierarchy is flatter: first names, and juniors are expected to speak up.
- ✓ Geography is part of practice: retrieval, telehealth and regional referral are normal.
- ✓ Rosters are generally respected, and annual leave is expected to be taken.
- ✓ You can change the shape of your career without changing city.



The clinical standard here will not surprise you. What surprises people is how quickly they are trusted with real responsibility, and how normal it is to leave on time. Ask about the department, not just the job title.

SOPHIE CAREEM, FOUNDER & CEO, ETHICARE RESOURCING

Do this in week one

- ☐ Enrol the whole household with a GP near home, not near work. Popular practices near good schools close their books.
- ☐ Save 111 (emergency), 0800 611 116 (Healthline) and 1737 (mental health, call or text) in every phone.
- ☐ Find your nearest late-opening pharmacy and accident and medical clinic.

Where to live in Auckland

Auckland is really several cities that grew into each other. A suburb twenty minutes from one campus can be fifty from another, so the right suburb is mostly a question of which way you drive in the morning.

Ask three questions, in order. Which hospital? Which side of the bridge? And, with children, school zone or square metres? The most sought-after zones carry a rent premium, and boundaries can run down the middle of a street. Families with more flexibility can go further out and enjoy considerably more house.

CENTRAL · ~10 MIN TO THE CENTRAL CAMPUS

Mount Eden

Villas and bungalows around Maungawhau. Close enough to the central hospital that plenty of people walk or cycle.

CENTRAL · ~10 MIN

Grey Lynn & Ponsonby

Restored villas, Ponsonby Road at one end, and one of the few places a car is genuinely optional. Popular with younger clinicians.

CENTRAL · ~15 MIN TO CENTRAL OR SOUTH

Onehunga

A real high street on the Manukau side, a train station, and central access at outer-suburb value.

NORTH SHORE · 5–7 MIN TO THE SHORE HOSPITAL

Takapuna & Milford

A swimming beach at the end of the shops, Rangitoto in the view. Milford is the calmer, family version next door.

NORTH SHORE · 12-MIN FERRY TO THE CITY

Devonport

A Victorian naval village with two volcanic cones. The commute becomes something you look forward to.

WEST · ~12 MIN TO THE WEST HOSPITAL

Hobsonville

A former airbase turned new suburb: warm, well-insulated houses, wide footpaths and a lot of small children. A common first landing.

EAST · ~18–20 MIN TO THE SOUTH HOSPITAL

Howick & Botany

A seaside village and a purpose-built neighbour, with strong schools, good value and one of the city's best multicultural food scenes.

SOUTH · ~20 MIN TO THE SOUTH HOSPITAL

Papakura

A southern town on the main rail line, close to the countryside, with the lowest rents in this list by a clear margin.



Villa-lined streets on the North Shore.

IF YOU REMEMBER THREE THINGS

- ✓ Choose the hospital first. In a city this size the commute defines the suburb.
- ✓ If you will cross the harbour bridge daily, try the drive at 8am before you sign a lease, so you know exactly what to expect.
- ✓ With children, check the exact address is in-zone. Many clinicians rent short-term first, then commit.

Getting around: car, train and ferry

Auckland has changed more in the last five years than in the previous fifty. Most households run a car, and some commutes are now genuinely faster without one.



The motorway spine at night. Shift work often misses the peaks entirely.

Auckland Transport runs buses, trains and ferries under one zone-based fare system. Get an AT HOP card in your first week: it is cheaper than cash and includes transfers. Four rail lines now run through the City Rail Link beneath the centre. The Northern Busway has its own road and often beats driving from the Shore at peak. Under-fives travel free.

The ferries are the quiet joy. Devonport, Half Moon Bay, Hobsonville, Birkenhead and Waiheke all leave from downtown, and the Devonport run takes twelve minutes. It is the best commute in the city, and the one people move suburb for.

○ Drive on your overseas licence

DAY 1

Valid for up to twelve months. Carry an official English translation or an international permit if it isn't in English.

○ Start the conversion

MONTH 1-2

Apply at an AA or VTNZ agent with ID, your licence and an eyesight check.

○ Hold a New Zealand licence

BEFORE 12 MONTHS

Some countries convert directly; others need theory and practical tests. Check your category first.

Traffic tips

- ✓ Peak is predictable: roughly 7 to 9 and 4 to 6.30. Shift work often misses both.
- ✓ Test a commute in term time; school holidays make every road look easy.
- ✓ Ask about staff parking at interview; arrangements vary by campus.
- ✓ The harbour bridge is the main pinch point. Leave a little margin at peak, or live on your hospital's side of the water.
- ✓ Allow an extra fifteen minutes when it rains, and expect the Friday drive home to start around two.



The city centre at night, where the train, bus and ferry networks meet.



The road north into Northland: the Bay of Islands is about three hours' drive.

What it costs to live here

Auckland sits at the top of New Zealand's cost range, with the country's highest wages alongside. We don't print rents or budgets here, because a number that was true when written is misleading a year later. What doesn't go stale is the relationship between places.

In short: housing will take a bigger share of your income than you are probably used to. Food is comparable. Fuel and cars are cheaper than the UK and dearer than the US. Eating out is reasonable, while alcohol and electronics cost more, because duty is high and almost everything arrives by ship.

Prices include GST, so the shelf price is what you pay, and restaurant bills carry no service charge or tip. Salaries are quoted as gross annual figures, and most healthcare staff are paid fortnightly.

Typical three-bedroom rent, by suburb



relative to the dearest suburb in our list (= 100); proportions, not amounts

CHEAPER THAN YOU'D THINK

Cars

The used Japanese import market makes a reliable second car genuinely affordable.

Being outdoors

Regional parks, beaches and tracks cost little or nothing. The default weekend is free.

Club sport

A season of junior football or netball costs a fraction of what arrivals expect.

Childcare at three to five

The 20 Hours ECE subsidy takes a real bite out of the bill.

WORTH BUDGETING FOR

Rent, by a distance

The line that shapes your budget. Plan it first and everything else follows.

Alcohol

Excise duty is high, so the excellent local wine and beer are best enjoyed as a treat.

Anything imported

Electronics, appliances, books, cosmetics, cycling kit.

Heating an older house

Newer and upgraded homes are warm; in an older villa, allow a little more for winter power.

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Unfurnished usually means appliance-free

No fridge, no washing machine, sometimes no curtains. Knowing this up front makes the first fortnight much easier. Trade Me and Marketplace are deep and unsnobbish; Kmart furnishes a kitchen in an afternoon. Delivery is often extra, so a hired trailer is handy.

Work out your own numbers

- ☐ Tenancy Services market rent: bond data by area, the most reliable rent figure in New Zealand.
- ☐ Sorted budget planner: the free, government-backed tool.
- ☐ Numbeo or Expatistan: compare Auckland against the city you are leaving. That is the comparison that tells you the most.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Auckland

Auckland is the one place in New Zealand where the clinical scale genuinely rivals what you left. You can go from a tertiary trauma roster to a community clinic without moving house, and that breadth is a real reason to come.

I always ask the same two questions first: which hospital, and which side of the bridge? The clinicians who settle happiest here chose their suburb around the commute rather than the listing, and planned around housing from the start.

And the first Christmas is a memorable one. Thirty degrees, a barbecue, light until nine. Ring home at their Christmas Eve, not yours, and then go swimming on Christmas morning. By the second year, that is the bit you wouldn't give up.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Day one: landing in Tāmaki Makaurau with everything you own.



A welcome bag from the new team, waiting on the first day.

Food, shopping and everyday life

Whatever you cook at home, Auckland almost certainly sells it. The trick is knowing which street to drive to, and that the city eats early.

There is no chain-coffee default. Independent cafés buy from local roasters, and an ordinary suburban café beats many specialist ones in Europe. The flat white is the default order, and ordering one correctly is a small, disproportionately satisfying first-week milestone. Cafés close by mid-afternoon; brunch, not dinner, is the meal the culture is built around.

Dinner starts at six or seven, and a 9pm booking is a late one. Auckland is more of an early-evening city than a late-night one: a swim after work, an early dinner, and the long, light summer evenings to enjoy.



Weekend market baking.



Brunch outside, which can comfortably take two hours.



Vines above the gulf on Waiheke, forty minutes by ferry.

CHINESE

Dominion Road

Hand-pulled noodles, hotpot and dumplings for a fraction of restaurant prices.

SOUTH ASIAN

Sandringham

Sweet shops, dosa, spices and halal butchers. The best-value dinner in Auckland.

PACIFIC

Ōtāhuhu, Māngere & Ōtara

Taro, umu and Saturday markets worth setting an alarm for.

GOING OUT

Ponsonby & Karangahape Roads

The polished strip for birthdays, and the creative street where newer kitchens open.

NORTH SHORE

Northcote & Takapuna

Korean and Japanese, plus the beachfront cafés.

WINE WITHIN AN HOUR

Waiheke, Kumeū, Matakana, Clevedon

Four wine areas close enough for an ordinary Sunday lunch.

Things that surprise people

- ✓ No tipping, no service charge. The menu price is the bill.
- ✓ A dairy is a corner shop. It has nothing to do with milk.
- ✓ BYO is real. Many smaller restaurants let you bring wine for modest corkage.



Fresh produce from a weekend market stall.



Green-lipped mussels, a New Zealand staple on seafood menus.

Weekends and the outdoors

East is the Hauraki Gulf: sheltered, island-scattered and calm. West is the Tasman: black sand, open swell and nothing between you and Australia. Most Aucklanders use both, for entirely different things.



Piha on the west coast: spectacular, with powerful surf. Swim between the flags.

40 min

coast to coast by
car

15 min

city centre to the
nearest swim

Feb

warmest sea, not
January

9pm

summer daylight
after a shift

The gulf beaches have golden sand, shallow entry and water in the low twenties by February. This is where families swim and where people go after work. The west coast is reached through rainforest, about forty-five minutes out, and is one of the great coastlines anywhere. Its surf is powerful, so learn the simple rules below before your first swim.

MORNING

Saturday markets

Farmers' and night markets all over the city, from Parnell to Ōtara, Matakana and the North Shore.

FREE

A volcano before breakfast

Maungawhau, Maungakiekie or Takarunga: a short climb, a big view, and coffee at the bottom.

SATURDAY MORNINGS

Junior sport

Football, netball, rugby, cricket and swimming clubs. Where most parents make their first friends.

15–60 MIN

Beach and regional parks

Mission Bay after lunch, a regional park picnic, or a bush walk in the Waitākere or Hūnua Ranges.

RAINY DAYS

Museums, zoo and aquarium

Auckland Museum in the Domain, the zoo, MOTAT and Kelly Tarlton's. Keep them for wet weekends.

SEASONAL

Festivals all year

Pasifika, the Lantern Festival, Diwali and summer concerts in the parks, many of them free.

Staying safe at west coast beaches

- ☐ Swim between the flags. If there are no flags, don't swim.
- ☐ Calm, darker water between breaking waves is a rip, not the safe bit.
- ☐ Caught in one, float, raise an arm and let it release you, then swim parallel to shore.
- ☐ Never swim alone, never after drinking. Check safeswim.org.nz before you drive out.
- ☐ The UV is fierce even on overcast October days: sunscreen, hat and shade from eleven to four.

○ The coast weekend

45 MIN

Market on Saturday morning, west to Piha by ten, home sandy and early. Sunday is the Domain and a bakery.

○ The island weekend

40 MIN BY FERRY

Waiheke for a vineyard lunch and a swim at Oneroa, then the six o'clock boat back.

○ The bush weekend

ALMOST FREE

A waterfall track in the Waitākere Ranges, then Maungawhau before breakfast on Sunday. Scrub your boots at the stations to help protect the kauri.

○ The city weekend

ON FOOT

A two-hour brunch, the gallery, Ponsonby Road, and dinner by the water.



One of the Hauraki Gulf islands, a ferry ride from downtown.



Waiheke: a bench, a bay, and nowhere to be.

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The thing that changes is not the weekends. It is that you stop saving them up. You can decide at nine on a Saturday morning to drive to a beach, and be swimming by ten, and be home for lunch. It sounds small. It reorganises how a year feels.

SOPHIE CAREEM, FOUNDER & CEO, ETHICARE RESOURCING

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Worth planning for

Family is a long flight away, so most people plan one good trip home a year and lean on video calls in between. If quick weekend hops to another country are high on your list, Auckland isn't that. But if you'd love Australia and the Pacific Islands a few hours away, many families come to treasure that side of the map.

Day trips and weekends away

Auckland is a base as much as a city. Islands, wine villages and marine reserves sit within an hour; the Coromandel, the Bay of Islands and Hobbiton make easy long weekends.

North of the city, Matakana's village market, wineries and the marine reserve at Goat Island make a classic Saturday. Out in the gulf, Rangitoto, Waiheke and the bird sanctuary on Tiritiri Matangi are all a ferry ride from downtown.

Further afield, the Coromandel's white-sand bays are around two and a half hours east, the Bay of Islands about three hours north, and Waitomo, Rotorua and Hobbiton within reach for a long weekend. Wellington, the capital, is about an hour away by plane.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
City beaches (Mission Bay, Takapuna)	~15–20 min	Calm harbour swimming, cafés and a promenade
West-coast surf (Piha, Muriwai)	~45 min	Black-sand surf beaches; the gannet colony at Muriwai
Ski fields (Whakapapa & Tūroa, Mt Ruapehu)	~4.5–5 hrs	Snow for a winter long weekend, or fly to Queenstown in under two hours
Hamilton (nearest other city)	~1.5 hrs	Hamilton Gardens and the gateway to Waikato
Auckland Airport	~30–60 min	The main international airport, south of the centre
Waiheke Island	~40 min ferry	Beaches, vineyards and walks
Matakana & Goat Island	~1–1.25 hrs	Village market, wineries and snorkelling in a marine reserve
Coromandel Peninsula	~2.5 hrs	Cathedral Cove, Hot Water Beach and quiet bays
Bay of Islands	~3 hrs	Sailing, dolphins and the Waitangi Treaty Grounds

~25 MIN BY FERRY

Rangitoto

Walk up the city's youngest volcano through lava fields and pōhutukawa forest, then picnic with a view back to the city.

~75 MIN BY FERRY

Tiritiri Matangi

An open bird sanctuary where takahē, saddleback and bellbirds go about their business around you. A day children remember.

~1.25 HRS

Goat Island Marine Reserve

Snorkel straight off the beach among snapper and blue maomao, or take the glass-bottomed boat.

~1 HR

Hūnua Falls

A waterfall and swimming hole in the Hūnua Ranges, with bush tracks for every age.

~2–2.5 HRS

Hobbiton & Waitomo

The movie set at Matamata and the glow-worm caves further south: a favourite weekend with visiting family.

~2.5 HRS

The Coromandel

Dig your own hot pool at Hot Water Beach and walk to Cathedral Cove. Busy at New Year, peaceful the rest of the time.

~3 HRS

The Bay of Islands

Paihia, Russell and Waitangi: island cruises, dolphins and the place New Zealand's founding treaty was signed.



Paihia in the Bay of Islands, about three hours north.



Hahei on the Coromandel Peninsula, around two and a half hours away.



Up the gondola on Mount Ruapehu, the nearest ski area: a long weekend from Auckland.



Hobbiton, at Matamata in the Waikato, about two hours south.



The glowworm caves at Waitomo, about two and a half hours south.

Schools and family life

Free regional parks and beaches, cheap club sport, playgrounds everywhere and the widest choice of schools in the country. Here is how families make it work.

Auckland is a big city that is easy to be small in. Children grow up outdoors: beaches, volcanic cones, regional parks and a playground in almost every suburb. Under-fives travel free on public transport, the city's library network is free to join, and public pools and leisure centres are spread across the suburbs.

Weekends fill up fast with club sport, swimming lessons, surf lifesaving and Scouts, which is also how most parents make friends. For many families arriving from larger cities, the pace and the freedom children have are the biggest change.

What the schools are like

- ✓ Most children attend state schools. There are also state-integrated schools, often with a church character, and independent (private) schools.
- ✓ Children usually start at five. Primary runs Years 1–6, intermediate Years 7–8 (often a separate school) and secondary Years 9–13.
- ✓ Many popular state schools run enrolment schemes, or zones. Living in-zone guarantees a place; boundaries can run down the middle of a street.
- ✓ Every school has an Education Review Office report, free to read at ero.govt.nz. It is the best way to compare schools on your shortlist.
- ✓ For three- to five-year-olds, 20 Hours ECE funds up to 20 hours a week at participating early childhood centres and kindergartens.

Start from the school, not the house. Work out which schools you'd want, check their zones, then search inside them. The North Shore and the central isthmus are the usual starting points, but zoning, not reputation, decides enrolment. Long-established schools such as Auckland Grammar, Epsom Girls Grammar and Rangitoto College have tightly defined zones.

For older children, Auckland has the most tertiary choice in the country: the University of Auckland, AUT, Massey University's Albany campus and several polytechnic campuses. Teenagers can study almost anything without leaving home.

Term 1

LATE JAN – MID
APR

The start of the school year and the easiest point to join.

Term 2

LATE APR – EARLY
JUL

Autumn into winter, and a settled term to join as winter sport gets going.

Term 3

MID JUL – LATE
SEP

Winter sport at its height, and a good stretch for settling into routines.

Term 4

MID OCT – MID
DEC

Short, sunny and full of end-of-year events. Many families arriving now enjoy the summer and start school fresh in Term 1.

Being a long flight from grandparents takes some planning, and it gets easier quickly. Club sport, school, church and cultural groups and the hospital social scene soon become a local village, and many families find friends here become like extended family.

Planning trips home



Cheapest fares: February to early April, and late October to mid-November.



Dearest: mid-December to mid-January and the school holidays. Book six to nine months ahead.



Plan one long trip of three or four weeks rather than several short ones.



You are never more than about half an hour from water, and within a month you'll check the tide before the weather.

Your Auckland address book

Auckland is home to more than 180 ethnicities, so almost every community has an association, a place of worship and a grocer somewhere in the region. South Asian life clusters around Sandringham, Mount Roskill and Papatoetoe, Pacific life around Ōtara, Māngere and Ōtāhuhu, and the Malayali community is large enough to support several associations and its own Syro-Malabar, Orthodox and Mar Thoma congregations.

COUNCIL & EVERYDAY SERVICES

Auckland Council

The region's single council: rates, rubbish, dog registration, parks and local boards
aucklandcouncil.govt.nz

Auckland Libraries

Free membership across dozens of branches, with English-language and community programmes
aucklandlibraries.govt.nz

Safeswim

Live water-quality and swimming-safety advice for Auckland beaches
safeswim.org.nz

GETTING AROUND

Auckland Transport

Buses, trains and ferries, the AT HOP card and the journey planner
at.govt.nz

SETTLING IN & COMMUNITY

Belong Aotearoa

Auckland-based settlement support and community connection for migrants
belong.org.nz

New Zealand Newcomers Network

Friendly local newcomers' groups; find the Auckland groups on the site
newcomers.co.nz

Auckland NZ (Tātaki Auckland Unlimited)

The official visitor guide: events, festivals and what's on
aucklandnz.com

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Auckland Malayali Samajam

Long-running Malayali association: Onam, Vishu and Christmas events, Malayalam classes for children; region-wide.
aucklandmalayalisamajam.org.nz

Yuvam Malayali Club

Newer Malayali club with cultural, sports, youth and women's programmes across Auckland.
yuvammalayaliclub.co.nz

Organisation of Hindu Malayalees NZ (OHM NZ)

Hindu Malayali families gathering for Kerala festivals and cultural events; Auckland-based.
ohmnz.org.nz

Auckland Indian Association

Central: Indian community association since 1921, based at the Mahatma Gandhi Centre, 145 New North Road, Eden Terrace; festivals, sport and events.
09 357 0665 aiai.org.nz

Migrante Aotearoa

Support and advocacy network for Filipino migrant workers and their families; part of the Pinoy We Care settlement network.
facebook.com/MigranteNZ

Council of Auckland Philippine Organizations (CAPO)

Umbrella body for Auckland's many Filipino associations; listed by the Philippine Embassy. Ask the Embassy for its current contact.

philembassy.org.nz

OneAfrica

Registered charity supporting Southern Africans (South African, Zimbabwean and neighbours) living in New Zealand; events and an active Facebook group.

oneafrica.org.nz

Auckland Irish Society / Auckland Irish Club

Central: Irish club at Fowlds Park, Mt Albert; pub nights, theme nights and St Patrick's Day.

aucklandirish.co.nz

CNSST Foundation

Settlement, job-seeking, counselling and family services for Asian migrants (and others); centres in Botany, Howick, Parnell and Glenfield (North Shore).

09 570 1188 cnsst.org.nz

Belong Aotearoa

Auckland's specialist settlement agency (formerly Auckland Regional Migrant Services); programmes for skilled migrants and free Safari playgroups for mums with under-fives.

09 625 2440 belong.org.nz

Auckland Council – Welcome to Auckland

Council's newcomer hub: settling-in guides, cultural and ethnic group directories, Welcoming Communities programme.

ourauckland.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/welcome-to-auckland

Ministry for Ethnic Communities – community directory

Searchable national directory of ethnic and cultural groups; filter by Auckland and by community.

ethniccommunities.govt.nz/community-directory

Citizens Advice Bureau (CAB)

Free, confidential advice on tenancy, work, rights and local services; branches across every part of Auckland, many with multilingual volunteers.

0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Community Law Centres

Free legal help (tenancy, employment, immigration, family) with offices in the CBD, Māngere, Ōtara and Henderson.

communitylaw.org.nz

English Language Partners – Auckland South

South: free English classes for residents, ESOL Road Code and English for work; centre at Westfield Manukau, classes in Papatoetoe, Manurewa, Botany, Howick and more.

09 278 9099

englishlanguage.org.nz/auckland-south

English Language Partners – Central & West

Central/west: centre in New Lynn with classes in Avondale, Henderson, Hobsonville, Massey and Mt Roskill; home tutoring too.

09 827 7882

englishlanguage.org.nz/auckland-west

English Language Partners – North Shore

North Shore: centre on East Coast Road, Windsor Park, with classes in Albany, Browns Bay, Glenfield, Takapuna and Orewa.

09 489 2078 englishlanguage.org.nz/north-shore

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

Auckland Malayali Samajam (Facebook)

Event announcements and community news for Malayalis across Auckland.

facebook.com/auckland.malayali

Yuvam Malayali Club (Facebook)

Club page for Malayali sports, cultural nights and youth events.

facebook.com/profile.php?id=61550769020382

Auckland Malayali Hindu Community (Facebook)

Festival and puja notices for Hindu Malayali families (OHM NZ).

facebook.com/Aucklandmalayalihindu

OneAfrica (Facebook group)

Southern Africans in NZ: questions, events, recommendations and newcomer help.

facebook.com/groups/www.oneafrica.org.nz

Migrante Aotearoa (Facebook)

Filipino workers' news, rights information and community events.

facebook.com/MigranteNZ

Auckland for Kids

Up-to-date family what's-on guide: playgrounds, classes, holiday programmes and markets across the region.

aucklandforkids.co.nz

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Mother of Perpetual Help Syro-Malabar Mission

Central/east: Malayalam Syro-Malabar Qurbana at Immaculate Conception, Ellerslie (Sundays and Friday evening); catechism for children.

syromalabarauckland.org.nz

Catholic Diocese of Auckland – parish & community directory

Find your nearest parish and Mass times; also lists ethnic chaplaincies, including the Filipino Catholic community at St Benedict's, Eden Terrace, and Chinese, Fijian and Cook Islands communities.

09 378 4380 directory.aucklandcatholic.org.nz

St Dionysius Indian Orthodox Church

West: Malankara (Indian) Orthodox parish at 55 Keeling Road, Henderson; Sunday school, youth and women's groups.

09 948 5215 sdiocnz.org

St Thomas Mar Thoma Church Auckland

Mar Thoma parish for Kerala Syrian Christians; registered charity based in the Royal Oak area. Contact through the charity register.

register.charities.govt.nz/Charity/CC32127

Holy Trinity Cathedral (Anglican)

Central: Anglican cathedral in Parnell; the diocese's Find a Church tool lists parishes across the region.

09 303 9500 aucklandanglican.org.nz

New Zealand Muslim Association (NZMA)

Runs Ponsonby Mosque (central, NZ's first), Avondale Islamic Centre, West Auckland Mosque (Rānui), Kelston Masjid and Birkenhead Islamic Centre (North Shore).

nzma.kiwi.nz

Bharatiya Mandir

Central: Sandringham Hindu temple, NZ's first purpose-built; Diwali, Navratri, youth, music and language classes.

bharatiyamandir.org.nz

ThiruMurugan Temple

South: Tamil Saiva temple at 145 Church Street, Ōtāhuhu; daily pujas, Thaipusam and Navaratri.

nzmurugan.org.nz

Gurdwara Sri Kalgidhar Sahib

South: NZ's largest gurdwara, Takanini School Road, Takanini; langar open to all, sports and education hub.

ourauckland.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/news/2024/05/gurdwara-kitchen

Fo Guang Shan Buddhist Temple

East: Chinese Buddhist temple at 16 Stancombe Road, Flat Bush; vegetarian tea house, classes; open Tuesday to Sunday.

09 274 4880 fgs.org.nz

Sri Lankaramaya Buddhist Temple (NZ Sri Lanka Buddhist Trust)

Sri Lankan Theravada temple in Auckland; Dhamma school for children, Vesak and Poya observances.

charitydata.co.nz/charities/new-zealand-sri-lanka-buddhist-trust

Auckland Hebrew Congregation

Central: Modern Orthodox synagogue on Remuera Road; runs Kadimah School and the city's kosher deli and café.

ahc.org.nz

Auckland New Zealand Temple (Latter-day Saints)

South: LDS temple dedicated April 2025 at 19 Redoubt Road, Goodwood Heights; meetinghouses across the region.

churchofjesuschristtemples.org/auckland-new-zealand-temple

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Lotus Supermarket

Central and south: big international grocer in Mt Roskill (64 Stoddard Road) and Manukau; Indian, Sri Lankan, Fijian and Middle Eastern ranges, halal meat.

09 620 7557 lotussupermarket.co.nz

Homeland Indian Mart

East: Indian grocer at 295 Penrose Road, Mt Wellington, stocking Kerala staples (kaima and jeerakasala rice, pickles, snacks); delivers.

09 527 0558 homeland.net.nz

Spice Supermarket

Central: Indian groceries and spices on Sandringham Road, Mt Roskill.

spicesupermarket.co.nz

Patel Brothers

North Shore: Indian supermarket on Sunnybrae Road, Hillcrest.

patelbrothers.co.nz

Other Indian grocers by area

East: A Spice Bazaar, Chapel Road, Flat Bush. West: Saffron Foods, Universal Drive, Henderson. North Shore: Wairau Foods & Spices, Glenfield. Central: Spice World, Avondale.

nrisworld.com/nz/auckland-indian-grocery-stores.html

Etihad Halal Meat

Central: halal butcher at 216 Richardson Road, Mt Roskill.

09 948 1215 muslimdirectory.co.nz

Tai Ping Supermarket

Asian supermarket chain: Greenlane, Newmarket, Mt Roskill, Mt Wellington (central); Albany, Glenfield (North Shore); New Lynn, Henderson (west); Pakuranga, Howick, Flat Bush (east).

taiping.co.nz

Golden Apple, LianHua, Foodie & Medol

Newer large Asian supermarkets: Golden Apple in Henderson and the North Shore, LianHua on the North Shore, Foodie at Westgate, Medol in Mt Wellington.

1news.co.nz

Auckland Hebrew Congregation kosher deli

Central: Auckland's largest kosher stockist and only kosher café, Remuera; meat, chicken, cheese, Friday challah, catering.

ahc.org.nz

Something From Home

Online South African shop delivering NZ-wide: biltong, rusks, braai gear and pantry favourites.

somethingfromhome.co.nz

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE

Cheapest of the big chains, for the fortnightly bulk shop; stores in every part of Auckland.

paknsave.co.nz

Woolworths

Formerly Countdown; stores region-wide and the strongest online delivery.

woolworths.co.nz

New World

Same owner as PAK'nSAVE, better fresh counters and bakery; dearer.

newworld.co.nz

Ōtara Market

South: Saturday from early morning to about midday, Newbury Street behind Ōtara Town Centre; the country's biggest Pacific market for produce and food.

thespinoff.co.nz/business/29-08-2025/a-handy-guide-to-all-the-markets-in-auckland

Māngere Market

South: Saturday morning at Māngere Town Centre; Pacific and Asian produce and food stalls.

thespinoff.co.nz/business/29-08-2025/a-handy-guide-to-all-the-markets-in-auckland

Avondale Sunday Market

Central-west: Sunday 5am to noon at Avondale Racecourse, 22 Elm Street; Asian and Indian vegetables in bulk. Bring cash.

thespinoff.co.nz/business/29-08-2025/a-handy-guide-to-all-the-markets-in-auckland

Central farmers' markets

Central: Parnell Farmers Market (Saturday, 545 Parnell Rd), Britomart Saturday Market (Takutai Square), Grey Lynn Farmers Market (Sunday, Grey Lynn Community Centre).

thespinoff.co.nz/business/29-08-2025/a-handy-guide-to-all-the-markets-in-auckland

North Shore & west markets

North Shore: Takapuna Sunday Market (Anzac Square). West: The Shed Collective, Oratia (Saturday); Catalina Bay, Hobsonville Point (Saturday and Sunday).

thespinoff.co.nz/business/29-08-2025/a-handy-guide-to-all-the-markets-in-auckland

East & rural-edge markets

East: Howick Village Market (Saturday, Picton Street). South-east: Clevedon Village Farmers Market (Sunday). North: Matakana Village Farmers Market (Saturday).

aucklandforkids.co.nz/auckland-markets

Auckland Night Markets

Street-food markets every evening, rotating between car parks (e.g. Pakuranga on Saturdays, Henderson and others midweek).

aucklandforkids.co.nz/auckland-markets

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts – Find a school

Search any address to see nearby schools and check enrolment zones before you sign a lease.

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

NZ Uniforms

School uniform stockist with Auckland stores in Albany (North Shore), New Lynn (west), Penrose (central), Botany (east) and Manukau (south). Check your school's own uniform shop and PTA second-hand sales first.

nzuniforms.com

Whānau Āwhina Plunket

Free Well Child checks for under-fives, playgroups, car-seat help; PlunketLine 24/7 advice.

0800 933 922 plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood centres for 0–6 year olds, with free parenting education; use the map to find one near you.

playcentre.org.nz/find-your-centre

Belong Aotearoa – Safari playgroups

Free multicultural playgroups for 0–5s at six Auckland sites, with English classes for mums.

09 625 2440 belong.org.nz

Auckland Libraries

Free membership at libraries across the region; storytimes, rhymetimes, holiday programmes and community language collections.

aucklandlibraries.govt.nz

Auckland for Kids

Kids' classes, playgrounds, school-holiday programmes and weekend events, updated weekly.

aucklandforkids.co.nz

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property – Auckland rentals

The main rental listings site; filter by district (Auckland City, North Shore, Waitākere, Manukau, etc.).

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/auckland

realestate.co.nz – Auckland rentals

Second major listings site, including rentals from private landlords; map view.

realestate.co.nz/residential/rental/auckland

Tenancy Services – market rent

Official bond data showing typical rents by suburb, property type and bedrooms.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Auckland Council – rates & valuation lookup

Look up any property's rates and capital value before buying.

aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/property-rates-valuations

Trade Me Flatmates

Rooms and flatshares, useful for a first few months while you get to know areas.

trademe.co.nz/a/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

Auckland Transport (AT)

Runs all buses, trains and ferries; the online journey planner and AT Mobile app give live times.

at.govt.nz/bus-train-ferry/journey-planner

AT HOP card & contactless

AT HOP is the fare card (concessions, account features); you can also tap a contactless bank card or phone.

at.govt.nz/bus-train-ferry/at-hop-card

Airport public transport

AirportLink bus every 10 minutes to Puhinui Station (Southern and Eastern lines); route 38 to Onehunga; SkyDrive express to the city.

aucklandairport.co.nz/transport/public-transport

Fullers360 ferries

Ferries to Devonport, Waiheke and Rangitoto from the downtown terminal; commuter passes available.

fullers.co.nz

InterCity

National coach network to Hamilton, Rotorua, Wellington and beyond.

intercity.co.nz

AA Driver Licensing

Book an overseas licence conversion online; AA licensing outlets across Auckland (map search).

aa.co.nz/drivers/driver-licences

NZTA – driver licences

Official rules on converting an overseas licence within 12 months.

nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo – Auckland

Crowd-sourced prices for rent, groceries and transport; compare with your home city.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Auckland

Expatistan – Auckland

Side-by-side city comparison; a sanity check on Numbeo.

expatistan.com/cost-of-living/auckland

Tenancy Services – market rent

The most reliable rent figures by suburb.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Stats NZ

Official inflation and household living-costs indexes.

stats.govt.nz

Powerswitch

Consumer NZ's free power and gas price comparison by address.

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted budget planner

Free government-backed budgeting tool.

sorted.org.nz/tools/budgeting-tool



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

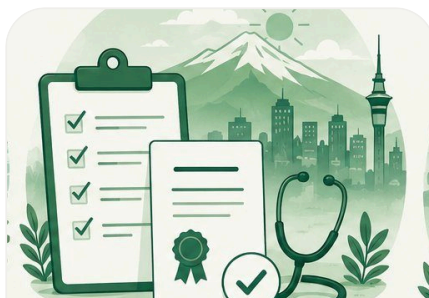
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

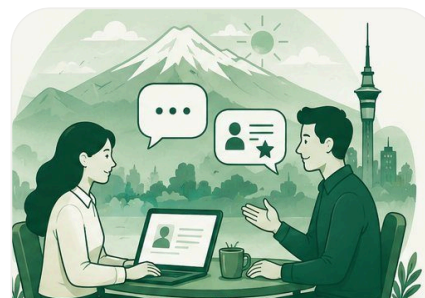
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

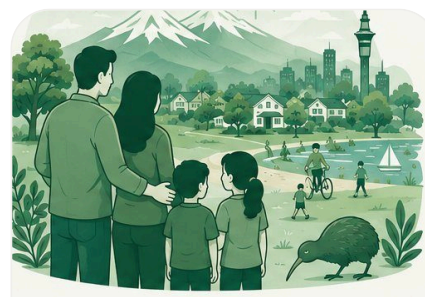
We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Auckland. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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